

Aesthetic Computer

Personal Computers Are Not Done Yet

Jeffrey Alan Scudder · LACMA Art + Technology Lab 2026 · Detailed Project Budget

Artist fee (24 months, Fall 2026 to Fall 2028)	\$22,000
Studio hardware (dev machines, displays)	\$3,500
AC Blank laptops (5 installation + 7 cohort × \$128 preloaded with AC Native, incl. shipping)	\$2,000
Mini Rig portable speakers for installation (5 × \$120)	\$600
USB drives, cables, peripherals	\$500
Installation fabrication (furniture, mounts)	\$2,500
Workshop materials (printed guides, KidLisp reference cards)	\$1,200
2027 Symposium “boot the cohort” (cohort demo USB kit, on-site workshop station, travel)	\$2,500
2028 Demo Day “play the room” (multi-station install setup, public-program support, v1.0 release)	\$3,000
Paid event helpers (workshop TAs, install + take-down at Symposium and Demo Day)	\$3,000
Server + compute infrastructure (hosting, CDN, CI/CD)	\$3,500
Documentation production (video, photography, translation)	\$2,000
Contingency (10%)	\$3,700
Total Requested	\$50,000

The 10% contingency line handles budget slip; paid helpers are a direct expense budgeted for the cohort’s two public events. Other funding: open-source sponsorship via GitHub Sponsors and Lib-erapay supplements ongoing infrastructure costs (hosting, domains, CI). Personal / studio funds cover primary ongoing support.

Milestones & disbursement by phase

Fall 2026 to Spring 2027	Hardware & Curriculum. Expand AC Native compatibility to 5+ laptop models, build the multi-piece boot menu, design the 3-level KidLisp workshop curriculum, produce printed reference cards.	\$10,000
Spring to Summer 2027	Pre-Symposium Workshops. 2 pilot workshops at LACMA, prototype multi-station installation, v0 of the open-source build guide.	\$8,000
Fall 2027	2027 Symposium “We boot the cohort.” Every laptop in the room becomes an AC Native instrument from a single USB stick; public KidLisp workshop; talk / in-conversation alongside the 2023 cohort.	\$7,000
Winter 2027 to Summer 2028	Full Installation + Extended Workshops. Kiosk-mode hardening, 20+ bootable USB drives for visitor take-home, 4 additional workshops, complete documentation, translated curriculum (EN + ES).	\$15,000
Fall 2028	2028 Demo Day “We play the room.” Multi-station AC Native installation premieres on the LACMA floor; visitors and artists play together across the stations; v1.0 of the open-source build pipeline ships alongside, so any institution can run its own room. Public programs introduce the system to teachers, museum educators, and artists.	\$10,000
Total Requested		\$50,000